

Activity 2 - Authorise the Pilot and Run the Kickoff Gate

Course: Effective Project Management for Small Projects (TGS-2020505545) Topic: 1 | Initiation of a Project
Learning outcome: LO1 Duration: 45 minutes Team size: 3-4 learners Tool set: Business Case on a Page and Project Charter

Objective

Define scope, success, authority and team arrangements for an executable small-project start (A1, K1).

The situation

The click-and-collect pilot has been selected, but Operations, Finance and the two vendors hold different assumptions about success, exclusions and decision authority. The sponsor will authorise delivery only after a concise gate review.

What you will do

Convert the selected option into a measurable business case and charter, define boundaries, name decision rights and conduct a short sponsor gate and kickoff.

What you will produce

A one-page business case, signed-ready charter, assumptions and constraints log, milestone frame, decision tolerances and kickoff action list.

Tool files in this folder

- [`tools/05 Business Case on a Page.docx`](#)
- [`tools/08 Project Charter Template.xlsx`](#)

Step-by-step instructions

1. Transfer the selection rationale and downside assumptions from Activity 1 into the business case.
2. Define measurable outcomes, benefits owner and the date on which benefits will be reviewed.
3. Write in-scope deliverables and explicit exclusions; test each boundary with the sponsor scenario.
4. Set five-month milestone limits, the S\$180,000 ceiling and quality/schedule tolerances.
5. Name the sponsor, project manager, core team and vendor interfaces; state the project manager's authority.
6. Record assumptions, constraints, dependencies and the top three high-level risks.
7. Run the sponsor gate: approve, approve with conditions, hold or reject; capture rationale and conditions.
8. Conduct a 15-minute kickoff covering why, what, who, how, decisions and the next 48-hour actions.

Evidence to submit

Complete [WORKSHEET.md](#) and attach/export the completed tool files named above.

Acceptance criteria

The charter names one accountable sponsor, measurable success, explicit exclusions, decision tolerances and an unambiguous authorisation decision within the small-project constraints.

Debrief

- The business case justifies investment; the charter grants authority.
- Decision tolerances make lightweight governance possible.
- Kickoff converts signed paper into shared commitments and immediate action.

The full procedure is also reproduced in the Learner Guide, Activity 2. The trainer deck contains only the briefing and success criteria.